

MIRAGE

Business Requirements Document

Friendship · Dating · Marriage

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Confidential & Proprietary

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1. Executive Summary

Mirage is a faith-integrated relationship platform that accompanies individuals through every stage of their relational journey — from making friends, to intentional dating, to marriage and beyond. Unlike conventional dating apps that focus solely on matching, Mirage combines social discovery, relationship mentorship, church-based counselling infrastructure, and a lifelong companionship model into a single, values-driven ecosystem.

The name 'Mirage' reflects the pursuit of something beautiful and real, a vision of lasting love that many desire but few know how to reach. The platform bridges that gap.

Mission Statement

To empower individuals to build meaningful, lasting relationships grounded in community, mentorship, and faith from first connection to lifelong partnership.

Vision

To become the world's most trusted relationship companion platform, where every user finds not just a partner, but a community and a guide for the full journey of love and marriage.

Core Value Proposition

- The only platform that stays with users from friendship to marriage
- Faith-community integration with church-vetted counsellors
- Anonymity-first counselling to remove stigma and build trust
- Open date request marketplace, anyone available can respond
- Free counselling tier through volunteer church mentors

2. Competitive Landscape Analysis

Mirage was benchmarked against the top five relationship apps globally to identify gaps and differentiators.

Platform	Primary Focus	Key Strength	Key Gap vs. Mirage
eHarmony	Serious relationships	Compatibility matching algorithm; 20+ years trust	No community/friendship layer; no counselling; ends at match
Hinge	Dating → relationships	Profile depth; prompt-based conversations; large user base	No faith integration; no counselling; no marriage support
Bumble	Dating + BFF + Bizz	Women-first messaging; multi-mode connections	No mentorship; no church layer; no lifecycle journey
Coffee Meets Bagel	Curated serious dating	Quality over quantity; balanced gender ratio; 50/50 split	No counselling; no community; ends at match
Tinder	High-volume discovery	Largest global user base; fast connections	Casual-first; no marriage support; no mentorship layer

Mirage's Competitive Differentiators

- Lifecycle approach: friendship → dating → marriage (no competitor spans all three)
- Church/organisation onboarding with their own vetted counsellors
- Anonymous counselling sessions — protecting dignity and trust
- Open date-request marketplace (no one-to-one lock-in)
- Free marriage counselling from volunteer church mentors
- Group and personal counselling modes for institutions
- Behaviour approval/recommendation system for community trust

3. Stakeholders & User Personas

3.1 Primary Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Role	Primary Need
Individual User	Core end-user seeking friendship, dating, or marriage	Safe, meaningful connections and relationship support
Church / Organisation	Institution onboarding onto the platform	Tools to vet counsellors, run sessions, and support members
Marriage Mentor	Experienced individual volunteering guidance	Platform to offer wisdom to couples anonymously or openly
Marriage Counsellor	Trained, vetted professional from a church/org	Structured tools to conduct sessions, manage caseload
Date Requester	User who posts an open date request	Quick, low-pressure way to meet someone for a date
Platform Admin	Mirage operations team	Manage compliance, fraud, payments, and quality

3.2 User Personas

Persona 1 — Tolu, 27, Single Professional

Tolu is a Christian nurse in Lagos looking for a serious relationship. She wants to meet people within her faith community, get advice from older married women, and feel safe before going on a date. She values anonymity when discussing personal issues.

Persona 2 — Pastor James, 52, Church Leader

Pastor James wants to provide structured premarital counselling through his church. He needs to onboard his church, approve trained counsellors from his congregation, and track counselling sessions without compromising member privacy.

Persona 3 — David, 31, Looking to Date

David is new to a city and wants to meet people. He posts an open date request and lets any compatible, approved person respond. He appreciates the community vetting system that gives him confidence in who he meets.

Persona 4 — Mrs. Adaeze, 55, Marriage Mentor

Adaeze has been married for 28 years and wants to give back. She volunteers as a marriage mentor on Mirage, offering free group sessions. She wants to remain anonymous by default until she trusts her mentees.

4. Functional Requirements

4.1 User Onboarding & Profile

- Registration via email, phone number, or social login (Google/Apple)
- Profile builder: name, age, photos, bio, faith denomination, relationship intent
- Relationship intent selector: Friendship / Dating / Marriage
- Behaviour badge: Users can be recommended/approved by church, org, or community members
- Profile verification: ID or church membership verification option
- Privacy settings: control what's visible to whom

4.2 Community & Friendship Module

- Community feed: posts, events, testimonies shared within the Mirage community
- Group discovery: faith groups, singles fellowships, interest-based communities
- Community join/request: public and private groups
- Events: churches and orgs can post singles events
- Mutual friends and connections graph

4.3 Dating Module

- Profile discovery: filter by age, location, denomination, intent
- Like / Super Like / Pass actions
- Match system: both parties must express interest before chat unlocks
- Conversation prompts to encourage deeper dialogue
- Open Date Request: user posts a date request (activity, time, location range); any approved, compatible user can pick it up
- Date feedback: after a date, both parties rate the experience (fed to match algorithm)
- Behaviour report: flag inappropriate behaviour for review

4.4 Approval & Recommendation System

- Any verified user can recommend another for dating/friendship
- Church/org admins can officially approve members as 'Recommended' for dating
- Approval badge displayed on profile (e.g., 'Recommended by Grace Chapel')
- Approval can be revoked if behaviour is reported and confirmed
- Users can see which community recommended a match

4.5 Marriage Mentorship Module

- Mentor discovery: find mentors by denomination, years married, and availability
- Mentor profiles: background, testimony, areas of guidance (communication, finances, intimacy, faith)
- Request a mentor: user sends request; mentor accepts or declines
- Scheduled sessions: in-app video/audio/chat sessions
- Session notes: private notes visible only to mentor and mentee

4.6 Counselling Module

4.6.1 Church / Organisation Onboarding

- Church registration: name, denomination, country, admin contact, verification documents
- Admin dashboard: manage counsellors, view (anonymised) session stats, approve/revoke counsellors
- Counsellor onboarding: church trains counsellors externally, then invites them to the platform
- Counsellor vetting: church admin approves each counsellor with a confirmed certification or endorsement

4.6.2 Counselling Session Types

- Group counselling: open sessions for multiple attendees (e.g., premarital group class)
- Personal counselling: one-on-one with a vetted counsellor

4.6.3 Free vs. Paid Counselling

- Free tier: counsellor voluntarily accepts a client for free; unlimited free sessions available
- Paid tier: if no free counsellor is available or user requests a specific counsellor, subscription fee applies
- Church can designate sessions as always-free for their members

4.6.4 Anonymity System

- Both counsellor and client can independently toggle anonymity
- Anonymised display: first and last letter of name shown (e.g., 'T***u O***i'), photo blurred
- All other identifiers (phone, email, church name, city) masked until trust is established
- Trust unlock: both parties mutually agree to reveal identity
- Anonymity logs: system records who chose anonymity for audit purposes

4.7 Marriage Companion Module

- Post-wedding onboarding: users who mark themselves as married transition to Companion mode

- Couples dashboard: shared space for couple goals, prayer requests, anniversary reminders
- Access to ongoing counselling and mentorship even after marriage
- Marriage health check-ins: periodic reflection prompts sent to both partners
- Resource library: articles, videos, and devotionals on marriage

4.8 Notifications & Communication

- Push notifications: matches, date requests, session reminders, messages
- In-app chat: end-to-end encrypted messaging for matched users
- Video/audio sessions: WebRTC-based in-app calling for counselling sessions
- Email digests: weekly activity summary

5. Non-Functional Requirements

Category	Requirement
Performance	API response time < 300ms (p95); page load < 2s on 4G
Scalability	Architecture must support 500K concurrent users at launch target
Security	End-to-end encryption for all messages; GDPR & NDPR (Nigeria) compliant
Availability	99.9% uptime SLA; zero downtime deployments
Data Privacy	Anonymity system must be cryptographically enforced — no server-side leakage
Accessibility	WCAG 2.1 AA compliance for all web interfaces
Moderation	AI + human review for reported content within 24 hours
Localisation	Multi-language support (English launch; Yoruba, Igbo, Hausa in v1.1)
Mobile	Responsive Vue PWA; native Android & iOS apps in v2.0

6. Technical Architecture

6.1 Technology Stack

Layer	Technology	Rationale
Frontend	Vue 3 + Vite + TypeScript	Reactive SPA; component-driven; strong TypeScript ecosystem
State Management	Pinia	Lightweight, composable; Vue 3 native replacement for Vuex
Styling	Tailwind CSS + HeadlessUI	Utility-first; rapid iteration; accessible components
Backend	C# .NET 8 (ASP.NET Core)	High-performance; mature ecosystem; strong for HealthTech/enterprise
API Style	REST + SignalR (real-time)	REST for CRUD; SignalR for chat, notifications, live sessions
ORM	Entity Framework Core	Code-first migrations; LINQ queries; strong .NET integration
Database	PostgreSQL (primary)	Relational integrity for users, sessions, orgs; JSONB for flexible fields
Search	OpenSearch	Full-text search for profiles, mentors, counsellors (builds on existing expertise)
Media Storage	AWS S3 + CloudFront CDN	Scalable; global delivery; signed URLs for private media
Auth	ASP.NET Core Identity + JWT	Role-based access control; church admin, counsellor, user roles
Video/Audio	WebRTC via Daily.co or Agora	Low-latency; in-app session calls for counselling
Email	SendGrid	Transactional emails; templates; delivery analytics
Push Notifications	Firebase Cloud Messaging	Cross-platform (web + mobile); reliable delivery
Payments	Paystack + Stripe	Paystack for African markets; Stripe for international
CI/CD	GitHub Actions + Docker	Containerised; automated test + deploy pipelines

Layer	Technology	Rationale
Hosting	AWS (ECS Fargate)	Managed containers; autoscaling; multi-region ready

6.2 High-Level Architecture

The system follows a layered, domain-driven architecture:

- Presentation Layer: Vue 3 SPA served via CDN (CloudFront)
- API Gateway Layer: ASP.NET Core Web API with rate limiting, auth middleware, and versioning
- Domain Services: modular services — UserService, MatchingService, CounsellingService, OrgService, NotificationService
- Data Layer: PostgreSQL via EF Core; OpenSearch for discovery; Redis for session/cache
- Background Jobs: Hangfire for scheduled tasks (reminders, digests, health check-ins)
- Event Bus: MassTransit + RabbitMQ for async domain events (e.g., match made → notify → log)

7. End-to-End Application Flows

7.1 Flow 1 — Individual User Journey (Friendship to Marriage)

Stage	Actions & System Behaviour
1. Sign Up	User registers with email/phone → selects intent (Friendship / Dating / Marriage) → completes profile → optional verification
2. Community Discovery	Feed shows posts, events, and profiles from selected community/church → user joins groups, follows people
3. Connection & Matching	User likes profiles → on mutual like, match is created → chat unlocks → conversation begins
4. Open Date Request	User posts date request (activity, time, location) → compatible approved users see and accept → date is confirmed → post-date feedback submitted
5. Recommendation	Church admin or trusted user recommends the person → badge appears on profile
6. Dating to Serious	Match app tracks relationship milestones user self-reports → prompts to consider mentorship
7. Engage a Mentor	User browses marriage mentors → sends request → mentor accepts → sessions begin
8. Marriage	User marks status as married → Companion mode activates → couples dashboard → access to counselling
9. Ongoing Companion	Periodic health check-ins → resource library → can request counselling anytime

7.2 Flow 2 — Open Date Request Flow

1. User navigates to 'Request a Date' screen
2. Fills in: preferred activity, date/time window, location (city/area), optional note
3. System validates: user must be approved or verified to post a request
4. Request is broadcast to compatible users who match requester's preferences
5. Interested users 'Accept' the request — requester sees a list of acceptors with profiles
6. Requester selects one person → both are notified → chat unlocks
7. Post-date: both submit feedback → used for algorithm improvement

7.3 Flow 3 — Church Onboarding Flow

8. Church representative visits Mirage and selects 'Register Your Organisation'
9. Submits: church name, denomination, country, CAC/registration number, admin details
10. Mirage admin reviews and approves within 48 hours

11. Church admin receives access to their Org Dashboard
12. Admin invites counsellors by email → counsellors create Mirage accounts with counsellor role
13. Admin reviews counsellor profile, certification, and endorsement → approves or rejects
14. Approved counsellors appear in the counsellor directory under that church
15. Church sets counselling modes (group / personal) and pricing model (free / subscription)

7.4 Flow 4 — Counselling Session Flow (with Anonymity)

16. User searches for a counsellor (filter: denomination, language, topic, free/paid)
17. User views counsellor profile — if counsellor is anonymous, only initials and blurred photo shown
18. User sends session request with topic summary
19. Counsellor receives notification (anonymised or named, per their setting)
20. Counsellor accepts → session is scheduled → both parties receive calendar invite
21. At session start, both join via in-app video/audio/chat
22. If either party chose anonymity: name is masked (first + last letter), video is blurred/avatar
23. Session concludes → counsellor adds private session notes → user can rate session
24. Trust unlock: either party can request identity reveal → requires mutual consent
25. Ongoing: multiple sessions can be booked; subscription billed monthly if on paid tier

8. Application Modules & Key Screens

Module	Key Screens / Views
Onboarding	Splash, Sign Up, Login, Profile Builder, Intent Selector, Verification
Community	Community Feed, Group Discovery, Group Detail, Events, People Nearby
Discovery & Matching	Discover Profiles, Profile Detail, Match List, Chat, Match Feedback
Date Requests	Post Date Request, Browse Requests, Accept Request, My Dates, Date Feedback
Recommendations	My Recommendations, Recommend Someone, Approval Badges
Mentorship	Mentor Directory, Mentor Profile, Send Request, My Sessions, Session Room
Counselling	Counsellor Directory, Counsellor Profile, Book Session, Session Room, My History
Organisation Portal	Org Dashboard, Counsellor Management, Session Stats, Approve Members
Marriage Companion	Couples Dashboard, Milestones, Health Check-ins, Resource Library
Settings & Profile	Edit Profile, Privacy Settings, Anonymity Toggle, Subscription, Notifications
Admin (Internal)	User Management, Org Approvals, Content Moderation, Analytics, Support Tickets

9. Core Data Model

9.1 Key Entities

Entity	Key Attributes
User	UserId, Name, Email, Phone, DateOfBirth, Gender, Intent, DenominationId, IsVerified, IsApproved, AnonymityEnabled, SubscriptionTier, CreatedAt
Church / Organisation	OrgId, Name, Denomination, Country, RegistrationNo, AdminUserId, IsApproved, CounsellingModes, IsFree
Counsellor	CounsellorId, UserId, OrgId, Specialisations, IsAnonymous, IsApproved, YearsExperience
Match	MatchId, User1Id, User2Id, Status (Pending/Active/Closed), MatchedAt, LastActivity
DateRequest	RequestId, RequestorId, Activity, DateTimeWindow, LocationArea, Status, AcceptedByUserId
Session	SessionId, CounsellorId, ClientId, Type (Group/Personal), ScheduledAt, Status, IsAnonymous_C, IsAnonymous_U
Recommendation	RecommendationId, RecommendedUserId, RecommendedByUserId, OrgId (nullable), Note, CreatedAt
Message	MessageId, MatchId, SenderId, Content (encrypted), SentAt, IsRead
MilestoneLog	MilestoneId, UserId, Type (Dating/Engaged/Married), LoggedAt

10. Subscription & Monetisation Model

Tier	Price	Features
Free	₦0 / \$0	Community access, limited likes (10/day), open date requests, free counselling (if volunteer available), group counselling
Mirage Plus	₦3,500/mo (~\$3)	Unlimited likes, see who liked you, priority in date request matching, 2 personal counselling sessions/month
Mirage Premium	₦8,000/mo (~\$7)	All Plus features, unlimited personal counselling sessions, advanced profile filters, mentor access, couples companion features
Church / Org Plan	₦25,000/mo (~\$20)	Org dashboard, up to 10 counsellors, group session hosting, member approval tools, basic analytics
Church / Org Pro	₦60,000/mo (~\$50)	All Org features, unlimited counsellors, advanced analytics, branded landing page, API access

Revenue streams also include: one-off verification fees, in-app event ticket sales, and premium resource library subscriptions.

11. Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Fake/unsafe user profiles	High	High	ID verification, behaviour approval system, reporting tools, AI moderation
Counsellor quality inconsistency	Medium	High	Church vetting + Mirage secondary review; user ratings; session spot-checks
Anonymity system bypass	Medium	High	Cryptographic masking enforced at API layer; no PII in client-side session state
Low early adoption	Medium	High	Partner with 5+ churches at launch; referral programme; free tier generosity
Subscription churn	Medium	Medium	Strong free tier; value ladder clearly communicated; companion mode as retention hook
Legal/safeguarding liability	Low	Very High	Terms of service; mandatory counsellor verification; incident response protocol
Data breach	Low	Very High	Encryption at rest and in transit; regular penetration testing; NDPR/GDPR compliance

12. Development Roadmap

Phase	Timeline	Deliverables
Phase 0 — Foundation	Month 1–2	Project setup, auth system, user profile, DB schema, CI/CD pipeline, design system
Phase 1 — Community & Discovery	Month 3–4	Community feed, profile discovery, matching, in-app chat, basic notifications
Phase 2 — Dating Features	Month 5–6	Open date requests, recommendation/approval system, match feedback, date history
Phase 3 — Counselling MVP	Month 7–8	Church onboarding, counsellor directory, session booking, anonymity system, video sessions
Phase 4 — Marriage Companion	Month 9–10	Mentor module, couples dashboard, health check-ins, resource library, milestone tracking
Phase 5 — Payments & Scale	Month 11–12	Paystack/Stripe integration, subscription tiers, admin analytics, performance optimisation
v1.1 — Localisation	Month 13–14	Yoruba, Igbo, Hausa language support; offline mode; native mobile app (iOS + Android)

13. Success Metrics & KPIs

Metric	Target (12 months)	Measurement
Registered Users	50,000	User table count
Active Monthly Users (MAU)	20,000	Users with login in past 30 days
Church / Orgs Onboarded	25	Approved org count
Counselling Sessions Completed	5,000	Session status = Completed
Match → Date Conversion	>30%	Matches that result in a confirmed date
Subscription Conversion Rate	>8%	Free users who upgrade to paid
Counsellor Satisfaction Score	>4.2/5	Post-session user rating average
Safety Reports Resolved <24h	>95%	Moderation SLA tracking
Marriages Reported via Platform	50+	User milestone logs (Married)

14. Appendix

14.1 Glossary

Term	Definition
Approved User	A user formally endorsed by a church, org, or trusted community member as safe for dating
Open Date Request	A publicly visible request for a date that any compatible approved user can accept
Marriage Mentor	An experienced married individual who offers voluntary relationship guidance
Counsellor	A trained, church-vetted professional offering structured marriage/relationship counselling
Anonymity Mode	A setting masking user identity (name truncated, photo blurred) during counselling
Companion Mode	Post-marriage features: couples dashboard, health check-ins, resource library
Trust Unlock	Mutual consent action where both parties agree to reveal their full identity
Org Dashboard	Administrative panel for churches/orgs to manage counsellors, sessions, and members

14.2 References

- eHarmony — <https://www.eharmony.com>
- Hinge — <https://hinge.co>
- Bumble — <https://bumble.com>
- Coffee Meets Bagel — <https://coffeemeetsbagel.com>
- Tinder — <https://tinder.com>

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